

PREJITH VARGHESE PONNACHAN

Demand Planning and Procurement | Automotive Aftermarket

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Demand planning and procurement professional in the automotive aftermarket, with four years across the GCC and UK. Runs the full order cycle for 17 brands and 9,000+ SKUs at Diamond Auto Spare Parts in Muscat, from enquiry and price negotiation through to customs clearance and goods receipt. Owns the range and the customs register, and builds the forecasting, reporting and control tools the business plans from, using Claude Code and Cowork alongside Excel and Python to automate work that was manual. Reports monthly to the General Manager and CEO.

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- Prevented a five-figure duplicate supplier payment by keeping an independent invoice-to-payment ledger and holding the balance until both accounts reconciled.
- Flagged pending purchase orders running at 2.7 times stock cover as a working capital risk, and escalated it before further orders were committed.
- Audited three years of supplier correspondence and found credit notes issued but never applied, with over half their value still undeducted. Set up a credit note register so they are offset against upcoming shipments.
- Built a demand-based order planning model covering 17 brands and 9,000+ SKUs, cutting purchase order preparation time by 70% with overstock checks built in.
- Analysed five years of ERP sales data to explain a first-half sales dip. Showed the core parts business had held its margin and traced the drop to a new anti-dumping duty on one battery line. Presented the findings to the General Manager and CEO before any decision was made.
- Led an inventory and working capital audit that identified 2,000+ dead SKUs for clearance and 900+ fast-moving lines under two months of cover with nothing on order.
- Own the company's HS code register for Oman customs (Bayan), covering 240+ items across 17 brands, and reconciled 234 of 235 product registrations against three years of records.

EXPERIENCE

Product Executive

Apr 2024 to Present

Diamond Auto Spare Parts, Muscat, Oman

Planning

- Plan procurement across 17 brands and 9,000+ SKUs sourced from nine countries in Asia, Europe and the US.
- Run weekly, monthly and quarterly ordering cycles by brand and lead time, raising 10 to 25 purchase orders a month.
- Forecast on Monthly Average Demand, with cover targets set by supplier lead time and adjusted for demand trend.
- Produced a half-year review from five years of ERP data that identified 2,000+ dead SKUs and the items carrying 80% of gross profit.

Procurement and suppliers

- Raise enquiries, review quotations and negotiate price against market rates, alongside MOQs, lead times and payment terms.
- Prepare purchase orders for GM sign-off, upload and amend them in the ERP, then track each one to receipt, expediting delays and raising the GRN on arrival.
- Reconcile POs against invoices and packing lists line by line, recently across 31,000 pieces over eight orders, and recover value on damaged stock through claims and credit notes.
- Source and onboard new suppliers, and settle payment by TT and Letter of Credit under EXW, FOB and CIF terms.

Logistics and customs

- Book freight forwarders for LCL and FCL against a gross-profit benchmark, and clear consignments held at Oman port.
- Maintain the HS-code register on Oman's Bayan system, and wrote the classification rulebook the customs checks run on.

Range and reporting

- Own the range for my brands, deciding what to stock and what to drop, and setting pricing and margin.
- Track stock turn and DOI by brand and the lines running below cover, and report monthly to the General Manager and CEO.

- Now building forecast accuracy by cycle, supplier OTIF and the rate of short shipments as the next measures.
- Work to brand principal targets, consistently met, and mentor colleagues on the order planning and customs methods.

Automation

- Run the planning and reporting workload on Claude Code, Cowork and Claude projects every day, for order planning analysis, invoice and customs checks, supplier correspondence and monthly reporting.
- Built custom skills that encode our own rules for order planning, HS-code classification and freight quote comparison, so the logic runs the same way every time instead of living in my head.
- Automated the monthly inventory close, which validates three source reports against each other and halts on a discrepancy instead of writing a wrong figure, taking a multi-day job down to same-day.

Head of Marketing and Strategy (Freelance, Remote)

Dec 2023 to Jan 2025

Puma Performance Pathway, sports performance company

- Built the brand architecture and go-to-market plan, and Power BI dashboards that fed into leadership decisions.

Marketing Officer, promoted to Systems Support Officer

Sep 2022 to Sep 2023

Netcom Training, Birmingham, UK

- Promoted within three months after taking ownership of the FLG CRM, then led a CRM optimisation that lifted lead conversion.

SELECTED PROJECTS AND CONTROLS

- **Order planning engine.** A MAD-based engine across 17 brands with lead-time thresholds and overstock prevention, cutting manual ordering time by over 70%.
- **Proforma invoice check.** Every proforma invoice passes ten gates before payment: layout, arithmetic, duplicates, version changes, price against last order, quantity against order, and the money position.
- **Supplier account reconciliation.** Rebuilt a three-year supplier account to zero, matching 177 statement rows to bank transfers.
- **Other tools.** A Python and Flask operations dashboard, an HTML pricing and stock app used by the sales team in the field, and a five-year sales intelligence workbook covering GP trends, account health and product-group performance.

KEY SKILLS

- **Demand Planning:** Demand forecasting (Monthly Average Demand, MAD), forecast review cycles, cover targets by lead time, stock cover and DOI analysis, ABC analysis, stockout tracking (lines below cover), replenishment planning, dead-stock prevention
- **Procurement & Supplier Management:** Enquiry and RFQ handling, quotation review and price negotiation against market rates, purchase order preparation, ERP processing and tracking, goods receipt (GRN), PO to invoice reconciliation, supplier sourcing and onboarding, negotiation of MOQs, lead times and payment terms, supplier scorecards, contract management, claims, credit notes and warranty recovery
- **Logistics & Trade Compliance:** Incoterms (EXW, FOB, CIF, CFR), freight forwarder selection and booking (LCL/FCL), landed cost control, shipment tracking and expediting, Letters of Credit and TT payments, certificates of origin and GCC documentation, customs and HS-code registration (Oman Bayan)
- **Category & Product Data:** Range selection and rationalisation, pricing and margin setting, product lifecycle and discontinuation, part number creation, OEM and competitor cross-referencing, item master and catalogue management
- **AI & Automation:** Claude Code, Claude Cowork, Claude projects, custom skill development, workflow automation, process documentation
- **Data & Reporting:** Advanced Excel, ERP data extraction and reporting, Power BI, Python (Pandas, Flask), working-capital and GP analysis, management reporting

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **MSc International Marketing Management,** Coventry University, UK (2021 to 2022)
- **B.Com (Professional),** Manipal University, India (2016 to 2020), with ACCA Diploma (9 papers exempt)
- **Certifications:** CMI Level 7 Strategic Management and Leadership | Six Sigma Yellow Belt
- **Languages:** English, Malayalam, Hindi